

*The imaginary lines on the earth's surface joining the north and south poles crossing the equator are known as **longitudes**. Such lines are also called **meridians**. *Unlike the equator which is centrally placed between the poles, any meridian could have been taken to begin the numbering of longitude. It was finally decided by an international agreement in **1884** that the zero meridian will be the one which passes through the **Royal Astronomical Observatory** at **Greenwich** near London. The zero meridians is also called the **prime meridian** or **Greenwich Mean Time**. *The longitudinal lines are not parallel to each other. The distance between two longitudinal lines is maximum at the equator (111.33 km). *East of the Prime Meridian is known as the Eastern Hemisphere and west of the Prime Meridian is known as the Western Hemisphere. *The 180° longitude is known as International Date Line. India completely lies in the northern hemisphere. *The mainland extends between the latitudes 8°4' and 37°6' North and longitudes 68°7'E and 97°25'E. The southernmost boundary of Indian territory extends up to 6°45'N. The southern part of India lies within the tropics and the northern part lies in the subtropical zone or the warm temperate zone.

1. **The expansion of India is between –**
 - (a) 37° 17' 53" North and 8° 6' 28" South
 - (b) 37° 17' 53" North and 8° 4' 28" South
 - (c) 37° 17' 53" North and 8° 28" North
 - (d) None of the above

39th B.P.S.C. (Pre) 1994

Ans. (d)

The area of India extends between 8°4' North to 37°6' North latitudes and 68° 7' East to 97° 25' East longitudes. The Tropic of Cancer passes almost through the middle of India. Thus, it is clear that none of the options are correct.

2. **The latitude that passes through Sikkim also passes through:**
 - (a) Rajasthan
 - (b) Punjab
 - (c) Himachal Pradesh
 - (d) Jammu & Kashmir

I.A.S. (Pre) 2010

Ans. (a)

The latitude that passes through Sikkim also passes through Rajasthan.

3. **70° East longitude passes through :**
 - (a) Jodhpur
 - (b) Jaisalmer
 - (c) Dholpur
 - (d) Nagaur

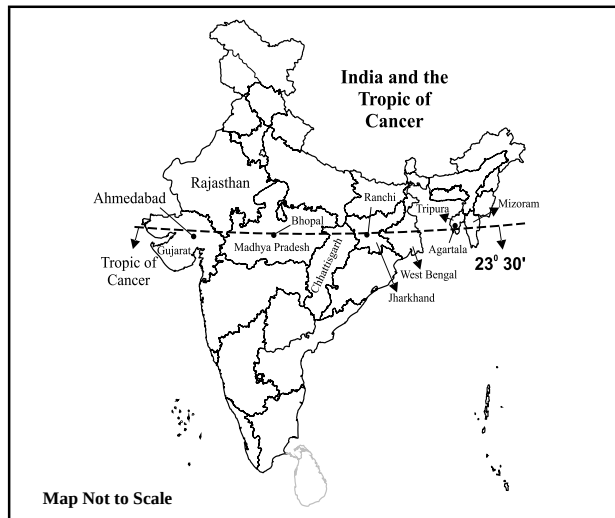
R.A.S./R.T.S. (Pre) 2010

Ans. (b)

70° East longitude passes through Jaisalmer, Rajasthan.

iii. India and the Tropic of Cancer

*The Tropic of Cancer (23°30'N) divides India into almost two equal parts. It passes through eight Indian states: Gujarat, Rajasthan, Madhya Pradesh, Chhattisgarh, Jharkhand, West Bengal, Tripura and Mizoram.



The duration of the days increases with the northward movement of the sun. The position of the sun on 21 June is vertically overhead the Tropic of Cancer.

1. **The Tropic of Cancer passes through which of the following states :**
 - (a) Odisha
 - (b) Bihar (Jharkhand)
 - (c) Uttar Pradesh
 - (d) Andhra Pradesh

U.P. P.C.S. (Pre) 1990

Ans. (b)

The Tropic of Cancer passes almost through the middle of India. It passes through 8 Indian states, namely Mizoram, Tripura, West Bengal, Jharkhand, Chhattisgarh, Madhya Pradesh, Rajasthan and Gujarat. Thus, at present none of the options are correct. At the time of examination, Jharkhand was part of the Bihar. Therefore option (b) has been considered as the correct answer.

2. **Tropic of Cancer is passes through which State?**
 - (a) Bihar
 - (b) Orissa
 - (c) Uttar Pradesh
 - (d) Meghalaya

70th B.P.S.C Re-Exam 2024

Ans. (*)

The Tropic of Cancer passes through a total of eight states in India, which include Gujarat, Rajasthan, Madhya Pradesh, Chhattisgarh, Jharkhand, West Bengal, Tripura, and Mizoram. Before 2000 AD Tropic of Cancer passed through Bihar. Now it is thorough Jharkhand. None of the options are correct. So the question is deleted.

3. The Tropic of Cancer passes through which of the following states?

Select the correct answer from the code given below:

1. Gujarat 2. Chhattisgarh
3. Uttar Pradesh 4. Jharkhand

Code :

- (a) 1, 2 and 4 (b) 1, 2, 3 and 4
(c) 1, 3 and 4 (d) 2, 3 and 4

U.P.P.C.S. (Pre) 2017

Ans. (a)

See the explanation of the above question.

4. Tropic of Cancer passes through –

- (a) Madhya Pradesh (b) Tripura
(c) Mizoram (d) All of these

M.P.P.C.S. (Pre) 2014

Ans. (d)

See the explanation of the above question.

5. Through how many Indian states does the Tropic of Cancer pass?

- (a) 6 (b) 8
(c) 7 (d) 9

Uttarakhand P.C.S. (Pre) 2010

Ans. (b)

See the explanation of the above question.

6. The state of India through which Tropic of Cancer passes is –

- (a) Jammu and Kashmir (b) Himachal Pradesh
(c) Bihar (d) Jharkhand

Jharkhand P.C.S. (Pre) 2011

Ans. (d)

See the explanation of the above question.

7. Tropic of Cancer does not cross which of the following states?

- (a) Tripura (b) Chhattisgarh
(c) Manipur (d) Mizoram

U.P. R.O./A.R.O. (Pre) (Re-Exam) 2016

Ans. (c)

See the explanation of the above question.

8. Which one of the following towns is nearest to the Tropic of Cancer :

- (a) Agartala (b) Gandhinagar
(c) Jabalpur (d) Ujjain

U.P.P.S.C. (GIC) 2010

U.P.P.C.S. (Pre) 1999

U.P. Lower Sub. (Pre) 2002

Ans. (b)

The place whose latitudinal position is at a minimum distance from the latitude of the Tropic of Cancer will be the nearest place to the Tropic of Cancer. The Tropic of Cancer is at 23° 30' N; divides India into almost two equal parts. Latitudinal position of the towns given in the options is :-

Place	Latitude	Difference in Position (23° 30')
Agartala	23° 50' N	-20'
Gandhinagar	23° 19' N	+11'
Jabalpur	23° 11' N	+19'
Ujjain	23° 09' N	+21'

According to the distance from the Tropic of Cancer, Gandhinagar is the nearest town. Thus, option (b) is the correct answer.

9. Among the following cities, which one is nearest to the Tropic of Cancer?

- (a) Delhi (b) Kolkata
(c) Jodhpur (d) Nagpur

I.A.S. (Pre) 2003

Ans. (b)

The latitudinal position of the above cities in context to the Tropic of Cancer is :-

Delhi	-	28°25' - 28°53' North
Kolkata	-	22°30' - 22°37' North
Jodhpur	-	26°0' - 27°37' North
Nagpur	-	20°35' - 21°44' North

The Tropic of Cancer is located approximately 23° 30' North of the Equator, so the nearest city to the Tropic of Cancer from the above options is Kolkata.

10. Which important latitude divides India into almost two equal parts?

- (a) 23°30' South (b) 33°30' North
(c) 0° (d) 23°30' North

M.P.P.C.S. (Pre) 2008

Ans. (d)

23°30' North latitude divides India almost into two equal parts. It is known as the Tropic of Cancer.

11. Which of the following statements are true?

- I. The Tropic of Cancer divides India into two halves.
II. The Tropic of Cancer divides Indian International boundary into two halves.
III. Maximum East-West expansion of India lies along the Tropic of Cancer.